

Class #6:

Dropout layers:

A regularization technique that randomly drops a fraction of neurons during training to prevent overfitting.

Purpose:

- Prevents over-reliance on specific neurons.
- Improves model generalization.

Batch Normalization Layer:

Normalizes the inputs of a layer to maintain a stable distribution of activations, speeding up training.

Purpose:

- Accelerates convergence and improves stability.
- Reduces sensitivity to initialization and allows higher learning rates.

Pooling Layer:

Pooling layers reduce the spatial dimensions (height and width) of feature maps, retaining important features while minimizing computational complexity.

Types of Pooling Layer:

- **Max Pooling:** Selects the maximum value within a pool, highlighting the most prominent features.
- **Average Pooling:** Computes the average value within a pool, preserving background information.

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- Reduces overfitting by downsampling.
- Increases computational efficiency and translation invariance.

Callbacks in keras:

Callbacks are functions executed at specific stages of the training process, such as at the start or end of an epoch. They allow monitoring, adjusting learning rates, saving models, or stopping training early.

Purpose:

- Enhance control over the training process..
- Automate tasks like saving the best model or adjusting learning rates.
- Improve model performance and training efficiency.

Example:

- **EarlyStopping:** Stops training when a monitored metric stops improving, preventing overfitting.
- **ModelCheckpoint:** Saves the model at the best epoch based on a monitored metric.
- **ReduceLROnPlateau:** Reduces the learning rate when a metric has stopped improving.

Common Steps in GANs (Generative Adversarial Networks):

Training Steps of a GAN (Generative Adversarial Network)

- Step 1: Generate Fake Data
 - The **Generator** starts with random noise and transforms it into fake data that resembles real data.
- Step 2: Discriminator Evaluates Real & Fake Data
 - The **Discriminator** receives:
 - **Real data** (labeled as **1**)
 - **Fake data** (labeled as **0**)
 - It tries to correctly classify whether the input is real or fake.
- Step 3: Compute Loss & Update Weights
 - **Discriminator Loss**: Measures how well it classifies real as **1** and fake as **0**.
 - **Generator Loss**: Measures how well the fake data is classified as **real (1)** by the Discriminator.
- Step 4: Update Weights
 - **If the Discriminator correctly identifies real as 1 and fake as 0, it wins.** Generator's weights are updated and discriminator remains unchanged.
 - **If the Generator successfully fools the Discriminator (fake data classified as real), the generator wins.** Discriminator's weights are updated and the generator remains unchanged.
 - **Only one model's weights are updated per training pass.** The losing model is updated. The winning model remains unchanged.
- Step 5: Repeat Until Equilibrium
 - Over multiple iterations, the **Generator improves at creating realistic data**, and the **Discriminator improves at distinguishing real from fake**.
 - At equilibrium:
 - The **Generator's loss is low**, meaning its fake data looks realistic.
 - The **Discriminator's accuracy drops to around 50%**, meaning it can no longer confidently distinguish real from fake.

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Key Concepts and Insights on GANs (Generative Adversarial Networks):

Question	Answer
Are GANs supervised or unsupervised?	Unsupervised
Whose weights are updated if Generator wins?	Discriminator
How are weights updated during training?	Alternately
Role of Discriminator during testing?	No role
When does training stop?	At Nash equilibrium
What does low Discriminator loss indicate?	Accurate classification
What does high Discriminator loss indicate?	Realistic data from Generator
Ideal loss value for Generator and Discriminator?	Around 0.5

📌 Variational Autoencoder (VAE):

A type of autoencoder that learns to generate new data samples by encoding input data into a probabilistic latent space. It consists of an encoder, which maps input data to a mean and variance, and a decoder, which reconstructs data from the latent space.

Purpose:

- Generates new, realistic samples similar to the input data.
- Used in tasks like image generation, data augmentation, and anomaly detection.

Example:

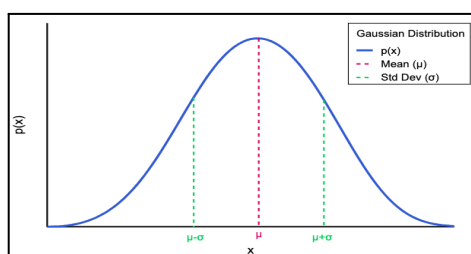
- Generating new handwritten digits similar to those in the MNIST dataset.
- Creating new faces by learning from a dataset of human faces.

🖋️ Gaussian Distribution / Normal Distribution:

A continuous probability distribution with a symmetric bell-shaped curve, centered around the mean, defined by the mean (μ) and standard deviation (σ).

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Graphical Representation:



🖋️ Central Limit Theorem:

As you take more and larger samples, the average of those samples will look like a normal (bell-shaped) curve, no matter how the original data is distributed.

🖋️ Key points to remember in VAE:

Point	Explanation
Encoder Outputs	Mean (μ) and Standard Deviation (σ) vectors.
Purpose of Mean (μ)	Centers the latent space distribution.
Purpose of Standard Deviation (σ)	Controls spread of the distribution.
Sampling Method	Random point $z = \mu + \sigma \cdot \epsilon$.
Why Sampling?	Enables varied and realistic image generation.
Random Noise (ϵ)	Sampled from $N(0, 1)$ for randomness.
Reparameterization Trick	Makes sampling differentiable for training.
Image Reconstruction	Sampled point z is fed to the decoder.

Sampling:

Process of choosing a random point from the latent space then sent to the decoder to reconstruct an image.

Reparameterization Trick:

A technique in Variational Autoencoders that makes the sampling process differentiable by expressing the latent variable as:

$$z = \mu + \sigma \cdot \epsilon$$

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where μ is the mean, σ is the standard deviation, and ϵ is random noise from a standard normal distribution.

The total loss in a Variational Autoencoder is the sum of:

- **Reconstruction Loss:** Measures how well the output matches the input.
- **KL Divergence:** Ensures the latent space follows a normal distribution.

Example:

In a VAE trained on handwritten digits, the total loss ensures the generated digit is both realistic (like the input) and smoothly interpolated in the latent space for continuous digit transformation.